
JOHN LEITCH

• THE ASCEND METHOD

THE PRICING CALCULATOR.

HOW TO USE IT (WITH A WORKED EXAMPLE)

TRACTION STAGE • RESOURCE 01

***A 10-MINUTE READ THAT WILL PROBABLY CHANGE
WHAT YOU CHARGE FOR THE NEXT 5 YEARS.***

THE CORE IDEA

MOST ACADEMY OWNERS UNDERPRICE BY 30-50%.

THEY DON'T KNOW IT BECAUSE THEY'VE NEVER DONE THE MATHS PROPERLY. THEY CHARGE WHAT THE ACADEMY DOWN THE ROAD CHARGES. THAT ACADEMY CHARGES WHAT THEY SAW THEIR OLD CLUB CHARGE. AND UP THE CHAIN IT GOES – EVERY ACADEMY IN THE COUNTRY ANCHORING TO THE NEXT ONE, LIKE A GIANT GAME OF BROKEN TELEPHONE.

THE RESULT: YOU'RE BUSY, EXHAUSTED, AND BROKE. YOU'RE DELIVERING QUALIFIED COACHING WITH SAFEGUARDING, PLANNING, ADMIN, AND CUSTOMER SERVICE FOR LESS PER HOUR THAN THE PARENT PAID TO PARK THEIR CAR AT THE VENUE.

THIS CALCULATOR FIXES THAT. IN 10 MINUTES YOU'LL KNOW EXACTLY WHAT YOU SHOULD BE CHARGING – AND WHAT YOUR CURRENT PRICING IS REALLY COSTING YOU PER HOUR OF YOUR TIME.

THREE NUMBERS THIS CALCULATOR WILL TELL YOU

- 1. YOUR REAL PROFIT PER SESSION (AFTER EVERY COST, INCLUDING TAX)**
- 2. YOUR REAL HOURLY RATE (INCLUDING PLANNING AND ADMIN TIME)**
- 3. THE PRICE YOU SHOULD ACTUALLY BE CHARGING**

WORKED EXAMPLE

MEET DAVE.

HE RUNS A TYPICAL UK ACADEMY.

DAVE RUNS A SMALL FOOTBALL ACADEMY WITH SESSIONS AT TWO LOCAL VENUES. HE'S BEEN GOING FOR TWO YEARS AND HAS BUILT UP A DECENT BASE OF REGULAR PLAYERS. HE WORKS HARD, HIS SESSIONS ARE GOOD, AND PARENTS LOVE HIM. HE'S ALSO CONSTANTLY SKINT AND CAN'T FIGURE OUT WHY.

LET'S RUN DAVE'S NUMBERS THROUGH THE CALCULATOR.

DAVE'S INPUTS	VALUE
CURRENT PRICE PER PLAYER	£5.00
AVERAGE PLAYERS PER SESSION	20
SESSION LENGTH	1 HOUR
VENUE / PITCH HIRE	£35
COACH COST (DAVE PAYS HIMSELF)	£25
OTHER COSTS (KIT, INSURANCE, ADMIN)	£10
TAX SET-ASIDE	15%
PLANNING + ADMIN TIME	2 HOURS

LOOKS LIKE A £100 SESSION. SOUNDS GREAT. WHAT DOES DAVE ACTUALLY KEEP?

THE TRUTH

DAVE'S SESSION MAKES HIM £5 AN HOUR.

HERE'S WHAT THE CALCULATOR TELLS HIM:

METRIC	Result
REVENUE PER SESSION	£100
TOTAL COSTS (VENUE + COACH + OTHER + TAX)	£85
PROFIT PER SESSION	£15
TOTAL TIME INVESTED (SESSION + ADMIN)	3 HOURS
REAL HOURLY RATE	£5.00 / HOUR
MARGIN %	15%
BREAK-EVEN PLAYERS NEEDED	14

THE VERDICT

BELOW UK MINIMUM WAGE.

DAVE IS EARNING £5/HOUR FOR QUALIFIED COACHING DELIVERY, PLANNING, AND ADMIN. UK MINIMUM WAGE IS CURRENTLY ABOVE THIS. HE COULD EARN MORE STACKING SHELVES IN TESCO – AND HAVE HIS EVENINGS FREE.

THE FIX

DAVE RAISES HIS PRICE FROM £5 TO £8.

SAME SESSION. SAME COSTS. SAME TIME INVESTED. NEW PRICE.

	OLD PRICE (£5)	NEW PRICE (£8)	CHANGE
REVENUE PER SESSION	£100	£160	+£60
PROFIT PER SESSION	£15	£66	+£51
HOURLY RATE	£5.00	£22.00	+340%
MARGIN %	15%	41%	+26PTS

BUT WHAT IF DAVE LOSES PLAYERS?

REASONABLE QUESTION. LET'S SAY DAVE RAISES TO £8 AND LOSES 20% OF HIS PLAYERS – DOWN FROM 20 TO 16 PER SESSION. A GENUINELY MEANINGFUL CHURN.

	20 PLAYERS @ £5	16 PLAYERS @ £8
REVENUE	£100	£128
PROFIT	£15	£44
PER HOUR	£5.00	£14.67

DAVE NEARLY TRIPLES HIS PROFIT – EVEN AFTER LOSING 20% OF HIS PLAYERS.

USING THE CALCULATOR

HOW TO USE IT.

FIVE MINUTES, MAX.

01

OPEN THE CALCULATOR

EITHER THE HTML VERSION (OPENS IN YOUR BROWSER) OR THE EXCEL VERSION. EITHER WORKS – PICK WHICHEVER YOU PREFER.

02

FILL IN THE YELLOW INPUT CELLS

YOUR CURRENT PRICING, YOUR COSTS, YOUR TIME. BE HONEST – INCLUDING THE PLANNING, ADMIN, AND PARENT COMMS TIME. MOST PEOPLE SEVERELY UNDERESTIMATE THIS.

03

READ THE VERDICT

THE CALCULATOR TELLS YOU YOUR REAL HOURLY RATE, PROFIT PER SESSION, AND WHERE YOU SIT ON THE PRICING SCALE (LOSS-MAKING → PREMIUM).

04

TEST A PRICE INCREASE IN SCENARIO COMPARE

(EXCEL VERSION ONLY) – TRY £1, £2, £3 MORE PER PLAYER. SEE EXACTLY HOW MUCH EXTRA PROFIT YOU'D GENERATE.

05

ROLL THE NEW PRICE OUT – BUT NOT THE WAY YOU THINK

DON'T EMAIL ALL YOUR EXISTING PARENTS AND ANNOUNCE A PRICE HIKE. APPLY THE NEW PRICE TO NEW JOINERS FIRST. TEST FOR 3 MONTHS. IF CONVERSION IS STRONG, THEN ROLL OUT TO EXISTING PLAYERS AT RENEWAL WITH 30 DAYS' NOTICE.

INTERPRETING THE NUMBERS

YOUR HOURLY RATE

MEANS MORE THAN YOU THINK.

YOUR REAL HOURLY RATE IS THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT NUMBER THIS CALCULATOR PRODUCES. HERE'S HOW TO READ IT:

RANGE	WHAT IT MEANS
UNDER £10/HR	BELOW UK MINIMUM WAGE – YOU'D GENUINELY EARN MORE IN RETAIL
£10-20/HR	WORKING POOR TERRITORY – ABOVE MIN WAGE BUT BELOW A QUALIFIED COACH'S WORTH
£20-40/HR	ROOM TO GROW – A SMALL PRICE INCREASE CHANGES THIS FAST
£40-80/HR	HEALTHY – YOU'RE EARNING WHAT A SPECIALIST SHOULD
£80+/HR	PREMIUM TERRITORY – PROTECT IT WITH DELIVERY, BRAND, PARENT EXPERIENCE

MARGIN % – WHAT TO AIM FOR

MARGIN	VERDICT
UNDER 20%	HIGH RISK – ONE BAD MONTH AND YOU'RE OUT
20-35%	DECENT – YOU'RE PROFITABLE BUT VULNERABLE
35-50%	HEALTHY – THE ZONE MOST ESTABLISHED ACADEMIES SHOULD BE IN
50%+	PREMIUM – STRONG PRICING POWER, PROTECT IT WITH DELIVERY

WHAT NEXT

RUN THIS TWICE A YEAR.

COSTS CREEP. PRICES SHOULD TOO.

MOST ACADEMY OWNERS PRICE ONCE AND NEVER REVISIT IT. THAT'S A MISTAKE. VENUE COSTS GO UP. INSURANCE RENEWS HIGHER. YOUR SKILLS GROW. THE MARKET SHIFTS.

SCHEDULE THIS CALCULATOR INTO YOUR CALENDAR TWICE A YEAR – ONCE IN JANUARY AND ONCE IN JULY. RE-RUN THE NUMBERS, SEE WHAT'S CHANGED, AND ADJUST ACCORDINGLY.

CONNECTED RESOURCES IN YOUR LIBRARY

WHERE	RESOURCE	WHY
TRACTION → 07	PROFIT FIRST FOR FOOTBALL COACHES	THE 5-ACCOUNT SYSTEM THAT MAKES PRICING STRATEGY MECHANICAL
TRACTION → 08	FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT TOOLKIT	P&L AND CASH FLOW – KNOWING YOUR WHOLE PICTURE, NOT JUST SESSIONS
TRACTION → 02	REVENUE GROWTH PLAYBOOK	HOW TO LAYER PRICING ON TOP OF LEADS AND RETENTION
OFFERS LIBRARY	PREMIUM UPSELLS (SCALING)	CHARGE MORE PER SESSION VIA 1-TO-1 AND VIP OPTIONS

**THE CALCULATOR GIVES YOU THE MATHS. THE
MATHS IS THE EASY BIT.
RAISING THE PRICE IS THE HARD BIT.**

IF YOU WANT HELP APPLYING IT, SEE 05 WORK WITH ME IN THE LIBRARY.

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